



Environment, Climate Change and Neighbourhoods Scrutiny Committee

Date: Tuesday, 22 July 2025

Time: 10.00 am

Venue: Council Antechamber, Level 2, Town Hall Extension

This is a **Supplementary Agenda** containing additional information about the business of the meeting that was not available when the agenda was published.

Access to the Antechamber

Public access to the Council Antechamber is on Level 2 of the Town Hall Extension, using the lift or stairs in the lobby of the Mount Street entrance to the Extension.

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Membership of the Environment, Climate Change and Neighbourhoods Scrutiny Committee

Councillors - Shilton Godwin (Chair), Kirwin-McGinley, Mumtaz, Ilyas, Razaq, Richards, Wiest, Foley and Mahamed

Supplementary Agenda

5. **Review of Waste, Recycling and Fly-Tipping - With a focus on approach taken in hotspots** 3 - 22
Report of the Strategic Director (Neighbourhoods)

This report provides an overview of Manchester's Waste, Recycling, and Fly-Tipping services, with a focus on hotspot areas. It outlines the key issues and ongoing challenges, the standards and penalties in place, roles & responsibilities, engagement & education, and approaches to behaviour change to drive long-term improvements.

Further Information

For help, advice and information about this meeting please contact the Committee Officer:

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This supplementary agenda was issued on **Friday, 18 July 2025** by the Governance and Scrutiny Support Unit, Manchester City Council, Level 2, Town Hall Extension , Manchester M60 2LA

Manchester City Council Report for Information

Report to: Environment, Climate Change and Neighbourhoods Scrutiny Committee – 22 July 2025

Subject: Review of Waste, Recycling and Fly-Tipping - With a focus on approach taken in hotspots

Report of: Strategic Director (Neighbourhoods)

Summary

This report provides an overview of Manchester's Waste, Recycling, and Fly-Tipping services, with a focus on hotspot areas. It outlines the key issues and ongoing challenges, the standards and penalties in place, roles & responsibilities, engagement & education, and approaches to behaviour change to drive long-term improvements.

Recommendations

The Committee is recommended to: -

- 1) Note the content of the report, the issues highlighted and endorse the key areas of work identified for 2025/26.
 - 2) Provide feedback on the key considerations identified for the future and any further recommendations arising from this report.
-

Wards Affected: All

Environmental Impact Assessment - the impact of the issues addressed in this report on achieving the zero-carbon target for the city

The Manchester Climate Change Framework 2020-25 is the city's high-level strategy for tackling climate change. It sets out how Manchester will 'play its full part in limiting the impacts of climate change', a commitment in the Our Manchester Strategy 2025-35. The Framework's key aims are to be: 'a cleaner, litter-free city, which recycles more' and '...play its full part in limiting the impacts of climate change and create a healthy, green, socially just city where everyone can thrive.'

Equality, Diversity and Inclusion - the impact of the issues addressed in this report in meeting our Public Sector Equality Duty and broader equality commitments
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Actions set out in the report recognise the need for just and equal delivery of clean & green services across the city, focusing on areas such as communications, engagement, education, enforcement and cleaner neighbourhoods.
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Our Manchester Strategy outcomes	Summary of how the contents of the report support the delivery of Our Manchester Strategy
Our People: Our People is about everyone who calls Manchester home, making sure they can live their best lives. Our People will: - Be healthy, happy and active from childhood to adulthood. - Have a great education and be able to learn new skills as they grow older, so they can get the best jobs. - Be proud of our diversity, feel valued and included, knowing they belong. - Participate, engage and influence decisions about their communities and neighbourhoods. - Be safe online and in person.	Supporting residents and businesses to dispose of their waste responsibly and compliantly will support the progress towards becoming a sustainable city. Working closely with both residents and businesses to support them in improving the neighbourhoods in which they live, work, and socialise.
Our Neighbourhoods: Our Neighbourhoods is about the places we live, making sure they're places to be proud of. Our Neighbourhoods will: - Have enough good quality, genuinely affordable homes. - Be attractive and well-kept with good facilities, services and green spaces.	Increasing recycling rates across the city will reduce Manchester's carbon footprint. Reducing litter will make the city cleaner.

Our City: Our City is about the things that will secure our future, that make us one of the best places in the world. Our City will: - Have a growing economy that provides jobs and equal opportunities for everyone. - Adapt to a changing climate and rapidly reduce its carbon emissions.	Eco Schools programme inspires young people supported development of green skills for the future.
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Full details are in the body of the report, along with any implications for:

- Equal Opportunities Policy
- Risk Management
- Legal Considerations

Financial Consequences – Revenue

None

Financial Consequences – Capital

None

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Background documents (available for public inspection):

None.

1.0 Introduction

- 1.1 This report provides a review of Manchester's waste, recycling, and fly-tipping services, with a focus on hotspot areas. It outlines the key issues and ongoing challenges, sets out the standards and penalties in place, and explores the city's approach to community engagement, education, and behaviour change to drive long-term improvements.
- 1.2 Further reports are scheduled to be brought to the Environment, Climate Change & Neighbourhood Scrutiny committee in 2025/26 related to this topic area, includes:
 - An update on the role of Neighbourhood Teams in keeping the City's Neighbourhoods clean, safe and vibrant, with consideration of their role as managers of place.
 - The annual update on Waste, Recycling and Street cleansing.
 - The annual update on compliance and enforcement which includes activity associated with litter and fly-tipping enforcement.
 - A report at the end of the year which describes the impact and outcomes of the investment to support clean and green activities across the city.

2.0 Strategic Context

- 2.1 As discussed at Environment, Climate Change and Neighbourhoods Scrutiny Committee, in June 2025, the Clean and Green work programme is focused on making Manchester a cleaner, greener and well-kept city. Waste, recycling and fly-tipping services are key priorities within this programme. It is recognised that to make a step change in this area, our approaches need to be co-ordinated, intelligence led and strategically aligned.

Our Manchester 2025-35

- 2.2 At the heart of the vision of the recently launched Our Manchester strategy 2025-35 is a commitment to clean, green neighbourhoods, and well-maintained public spaces. Manchester aims to be a vibrant, safe, and environmentally conscious city that all residents can take pride in. As part of the Our Manchester consultation, residents have told us they care deeply about their local areas but don't always feel proud of them.

Making Manchester Fairer

- 2.3 Making Manchester Fairer is the city's long-term action plan to reduce health and social inequalities by addressing the root causes of disadvantage. The strategy aims to ensure that all residents - regardless of background or neighbourhood - have equal opportunities to live healthy, fulfilling lives and reach their full potential. Grounded in evidence and shaped by the voices of residents and local organisations, the plan focuses on collaborative action to tackle poverty, improve wellbeing, and create a fairer, more inclusive Manchester.

Zero Carbon Manchester

- 2.4 Manchester's Zero Carbon Strategy sets out the city's ambition to become a zero-carbon city by 2038. The strategy aims to create a healthy, green, and socially just city where everyone can thrive. It focuses on reducing carbon emissions across all sectors, including transport, buildings, and energy, while supporting residents and businesses to make low-carbon choices and consider the things they buy and throw away.

3.0 Background

- 3.1 Manchester's ambition is to become a cleaner, litter-free city - where residents and businesses are more mindful of consumption and waste, fly-tipping is reduced and re-use and recycling rates are improved. These objectives underpin several key strategies, policies, and action plans. This commitment reflects the city's broader goals around environmental sustainability, neighbourhood pride, and long-term climate resilience. The approach is supported by a robust legislative framework, including the Environmental Protection Act 1990, the Simpler Recycling reforms, and Duty of Care obligations applicable to both households and commercial entities.
- 3.2 Local authorities have a statutory responsibility to ensure the regular collection of household waste to prevent accumulation and safeguard public health. In addition, councils are required to provide separate recycling collections, to support environmental sustainability and meet legal requirements set out in 'Simpler Recycling' legislation (Waste Strategy, 2018). Councils must also remove fly-tipped waste from public land and highways promptly. They are empowered to investigate incidents, take enforcement action against offenders, issue penalties, and implement preventative measures to reduce the occurrence of fly-tipping.
- 3.3 Waste, recycling, and street cleansing services are essential to maintaining clean, attractive, and welcoming environments across Manchester's communities. These services are part of everyday life for most residents - whether through routine activities such as presenting bins for collection, disposing of excess waste at Household Waste Recycling Centres or using public litter bins while out in the city.
- 3.4 The waste disposal and recycling arrangements for Manchester and other Greater Manchester Authorities (except. Wigan) are managed by the Greater Manchester Combined Authority (GMCA). The operating contract for the disposal and recycling facilities, together with Household Waste Recycling Centre's (HWRCs) is delivered by Suez.
- 3.5 The Council's main service provider Biffa is responsible for providing scheduled domestic waste and recycling bin collections; scheduled and reactive street cleansing services; delivery and collection of bins, bulky waste collections, and reactive / pro-active fly-tip removal services for defined land types.

3.6 The Neighbourhoods Directorate plays a vital role in maintaining Manchester as a clean, safe, and vibrant city in which to live, work, and visit. It is responsible for delivering a range of statutory services alongside community engagement and educational initiatives. The Directorate adopts a collaborative approach, bringing together services to jointly plan and respond to areas requiring targeted attention or improvement. Within this structure, the Waste, Recycling and Street Cleansing Team operates under the Neighbourhood Delivery function. This team manages the city's waste and street cleansing contract, oversees domestic waste disposal arrangements, leads service improvement initiatives, and co-ordinates the 'Keep Manchester Tidy' campaign. It works in close partnership with other neighbourhood services, particularly the Neighbourhood Teams who focus on engagement, education, and place-based coordination and the Neighbourhood Compliance Teams, who are responsible for enforcement activities, to deliver shared priorities across communities.

3.7 The current operational model is structured around three core principles:

- Engage: Empowering communities to take ownership.
- Educate: Promoting awareness and understanding.
- Enforce: Ensuring compliance through proportionate action.

4.0 Waste, Recycling, and Cleansing – Service Standards

Council and Contractor Service Standards

4.1 MCC has two key suppliers that are contracted to deliver these statutory services. Biffa provides household bin collection and street cleansing services. Redgate provides collection, disposal and recycling of street cleansing and bulky waste. Grounds Maintenance provides litter removal and litter bin emptying in most parks and green spaces. The Council and its Contractors are expected to:

- Meet service standards/SLAs in dealing with requests for service from residents,
- Collaborate on shared neighbourhood management priorities and align/sequence resources/capacity to respond.
- Effectively monitor contractors delivering services on our behalf against agreed service standards.

4.1.1 The Council's collections provider (Biffa) is required to:

- Provide timely removal of fly-tipping (within 5 working days).
- Removing hazardous waste (within 24 hours).
- Maintaining street cleanliness through scheduled and responsive services.
- Delivering and removing bins within 5 working days, where requested.
- Emptying litter bins and removing graffiti within set timeframes.
- Supporting assisted collections and additional capacity requests.

Community Engagement Standards

4.1.2 Neighbourhood Officers are required to:

- Promote reporting through the contact centre and My Account.
- Engage residents through Clean & Green Locality Groups.
- Use data to drive service delivery and identify under-reporting.
- Support community-led clean-up efforts and promote volunteering via MCRVIP.
- Encourage responsible waste disposal and recycling behaviour.

Resident and Business Penalties

4.1.3 The Council has enforcement powers to tackle issues of non-compliance:

- **Section 46 EPA 1990:** £80 FPN for non-compliance with waste presentation.
- **Littering:** Up to £2,500 fine; FPNs issued with reduced rates for early payment.
- **Fly-tipping:** Unlimited fines or 12 months' imprisonment; £400 FPN for household duty of care breaches.
- **Community Protection Notices (CPNs):** £100 FPNs for non-compliance; up to £2,500 (individuals) or £20,000 (businesses) on conviction.
- **Pest Control (PDA 1949):** Enforcement for vermin harbourage; costs recoverable.
- **Commercial Waste:** £300 FPN for missing waste transfer notes; up to £5,000 fine.
- **Section 47 Notices:** £110 FPN for improper waste storage or disposal; up to £1,000 fine if prosecuted.

Role of Residents

4.2 The Council provides a recycling-led service, and all residents are expected to manage their waste legally and recycle their waste in accordance with the services provided. In Manchester, household bin collection services are organised into three main categories based on the type of housing and bin storage space. Most households - approximately 157,000 (63%) are classified as four-bin households, where each property has its own general waste bin along with three separate recycling bins. 77,300 households (31%) are in apartment buildings where residents use shared communal rubbish and recycling facilities, which may consist of containers or wheelie bins depending on the building size. For the remaining 15,000 households (6%), located in terraced streets with limited space, shared collection containers placed in passageways. Residents are expected to:

- Present bins correctly on scheduled collection days / returning onto property after (4 bin households)
- Use the correct bins for recycling, food, garden, and general waste.
- Avoid contaminating recycling bins with incorrect materials.
- Avoiding presentation of side waste.
- Present waste & recycling bins on the correct days for collection.

- Manage excess waste via bulky collection, access to HWRCs (tips), skips or registered waste providers.
- Not tolerate other people disrespecting where they live, and report neighbourhood management issues when they are happening via email / phone / My Account (and their RP / Landlord / other stakeholders where appropriate).

Role of Businesses

4.3 Businesses are expected to comply with waste legislation and planning requirements:

- Keep their land clean & tidy.
- Dispose of their waste appropriately.
- If commercial waste is dealt with by someone else, they must be properly authorised (have a waste carriers license).
- Keep documentary evidence of how they dispose of their waste
- Waste from their business must be properly contained and secure at all time.
- Reinforce standards among their employees.
- Report other businesses who don't respect their neighbourhoods.
- Be good neighbours.

Role of Landlords and Housing Providers

4.4 Landlords are expected to:

- Keep their land clean & tidy.
- Dispose of their waste (arising from property repair and maintenance) appropriately.
- Ensure tenants have the appropriate and adequate facilities to store rubbish and recycling.
- Ensure tenants understand how they can legitimately get rid of excess waste.
- Ensure tenants have keys to alley gates where appropriate and how to get a duplicate key if lost.
- Reinforce standards among their tenants.
- Make sure that tenants are storing and separating their recycling and rubbish and placing it for collection as required.
- Dispose of waste appropriately if left by tenants.
- Make sure their tenants know how to report any neighbourhood management issues.

Role of Members

4.5 Members can support this agenda by:

- Encouraging residents to self-report.

- Report neighbourhood management issues to the MCC Contact Centre through their dedicated reporting channels (phone / email / My Account).
- Maintain focus on priority areas for intensive approaches e.g. phased approach for Intensive Neighbourhood Management areas.

5.0 Performance Data and Governance Arrangements

5.1 As discussed at Environment, Climate Change and Neighbourhoods Scrutiny Committee (ECCNSC) in June 2025, a performance dashboard has been developed to support strategic performance monitoring and collaboration across Neighbourhoods services, Ward Co-ordination and external partners. It offers:

- Consistent KPIs for each ward, showing performance against service standards, service demand and access.
- Service narratives to interpret the data.
- Insights into trends and changes across all 32 wards.
- A basis for quarterly reviews and multi-agency resource planning.
- Ongoing influence on Ward Plan priorities and future resource allocation.
- Key contract performance information for the waste collection, street cleansing and fly-tip removal service.
- Information about waste related engagement at a ward level.
- Waste related compliance and enforcement action at a at a ward level.

5.2 As discussed previously at ECCSC in November 2024, a robust governance arrangement exists for the waste contract. In 2024/25, a new Clean & Green governance arrangement was introduced to complement existing Board arrangements and provide strategic oversight and drive place-based leadership for clean & green priorities across the Neighbourhoods Directorate. This includes Clean & Green locality groups and Ward Co-ordination, which engage wider stakeholders in addressing environmental priorities. Central to this structure is the Clean & Green Board, chaired by the Strategic Director for Neighbourhoods and supported by Executive Members for Vibrant Neighbourhoods, Housing & Development, and Clean Air, Environment & Transport.

5.3 A key aim of the refreshed governance arrangements is to strengthen the connection between local issues and resource decisions, ensuring a more co-ordinated and effective approach. This includes monitoring performance at both ward and neighbourhood levels, supporting targeted interventions, and guiding the allocation of resources where they are most needed.

6.0 Our Current Approach

Our resourcing

6.1 This is a summary of the key Council resources which supports this area of work, in addition to the resources provided by the collections contractor (Biffa) and recycling / disposal arrangements (Redgate & GMCA).

- £30k per year for 25/26-27/28 – additional funding for the NTs to test different comms approaches out (building on existing resources from the MCC Comms Team/services).
- £640k Neighbourhood Investment Fund (NIF)- £20k per Ward - funds community led projects, which deliver Ward priorities- clean-ups/alley-way greening, community/celebration events+. 860 projects 24/25.
- £15m Neighbourhood Infrastructure Renewal Fund over 3 years – focused on improving how neighbourhoods 'look & feel' and function, which helps strengthen relationships with community groups and residents.
- Key focus of Neighbourhood Teams across all wards -Neighbourhood Managers; Neighbourhood Officers; Neighbourhood Community Development Officers (new).
- Neighbourhood Compliance - area teams across North, Central and South; Neighbourhood Project Team with specific focus on waste.
- Keep Manchester Tidy Team.
- Waste Contract Client Team & Service Improvement.
- Citywide Teams with touchpoints relevant to this area – Housing Services, Housing Compliance, Trading Standards, Environmental Protection Team
- McrVIP – Manchester Volunteer Inspire Programme - 7.5k volunteers registered. Developing Volunteering strategy on Clean & Green.
- Annual Be Proud Awards – recognises the voluntary contribution of residents (award on keeping areas clean and tidy).

Our approach

- 6.2 Table 3 provides an overview of the Councils approach to managing waste, recycling and fly-tipping, which is structured around the core principals to engage, educate and enforce.

Table 3 Overview of our approach

Promote valid disposal routes	Bulky removal service	- Households entitled to one free collection per year. Paid for collection thereafter.
	HWRCs / tips	- open 8 am – 8 pm, 7 days a week, 3 in the city - re-use hub
Engagement	Neighbourhood Teams	- Local engagement about priority issues / how places 'look & feel' inc. Fly tipping and other neighbourhood management related issues. - Build community power / more resilient communities, - Influencing the targeting of service / partner resources.
	Biffa Social Value / R4GM	- Support community events and deliver education programmes in schools.
Education	Keep Manchester Tidy	- Campaigns developed with KBT inc. GB Spring Clean - Insight and support to understand behaviours via KBT.
	Biffa / Compliance Fly tip Investigation Team	- Fly tipping hot spots visited proactively. - Waste searched to identify perpetrator. - Evidence passed to enforcement team.
Enforcement	Neighbourhood Compliance Teams	- Respond to reports of fly tipping (reporter willing to provide evidence), untidy private land, & commercial waste issues. - Joint operations to address non-compliance with waste issues
	Proactive fly tip Investigation & target hardening	- extra CCTV cameras & Compliance Officers (commercial waste) - 40 target hardening projects since 2019 (15 currently in progress)
Removal	Biffa fly tip removal teams	- Reactive service. Remove reported fly tipping within 5 working days.

Education

6.3 Below is an overview of the current approach to education:

- Instructional information – annual recycling calendar, webpages, how to report issues to the Council and other relevant landowners.
- Recycling and waste management campaigns to align with national campaigns and key seasonal issues e.g Christmas tree campaign.
- Young people: Eco Schools, Climate Change Assemblies, and the Biffa Social Value Team (assemblies, events and workshops).
- Carbon Literacy training.

Engagement (target audience approach)

6.4 Overview of the current approach to engagement:

- There is strong engagement with Manchester Housing Providers Partnership, but recognise that some RPs more engaged than others.
- Working relationships have been formed with TfGM and other key landowners in the city as part of 'Clean and Green'.
- There is good engagement via Housing Compliance with private landlords in student areas, including on waste.
- Engagement takes place with businesses on waste and other matters on regular basis.
- Engagement with Residents & Community Groups / VCS groups / Area Youth Forums (social media channels via admins of WhatsApp groups on estates / Facebook groups (M18 in Gorton has over 20k residents)).
- We work with Making Manchester Fairer Community Forum on bespoke approaches with diverse communities (sounding board approach) for their ideas on engagement / education to tackle neighbourhood management issues).
- There is joint City Council insight / ideas together on VCS groups we fund (their role in helping) e.g. OMVCS / Macc who are supporting groups, Community Health Equity Manchester (CHEM).
- Engagement with Universities linked to students.
- Compliance teams work closely with Homelessness Services to address waste issues in dispersed accommodation.

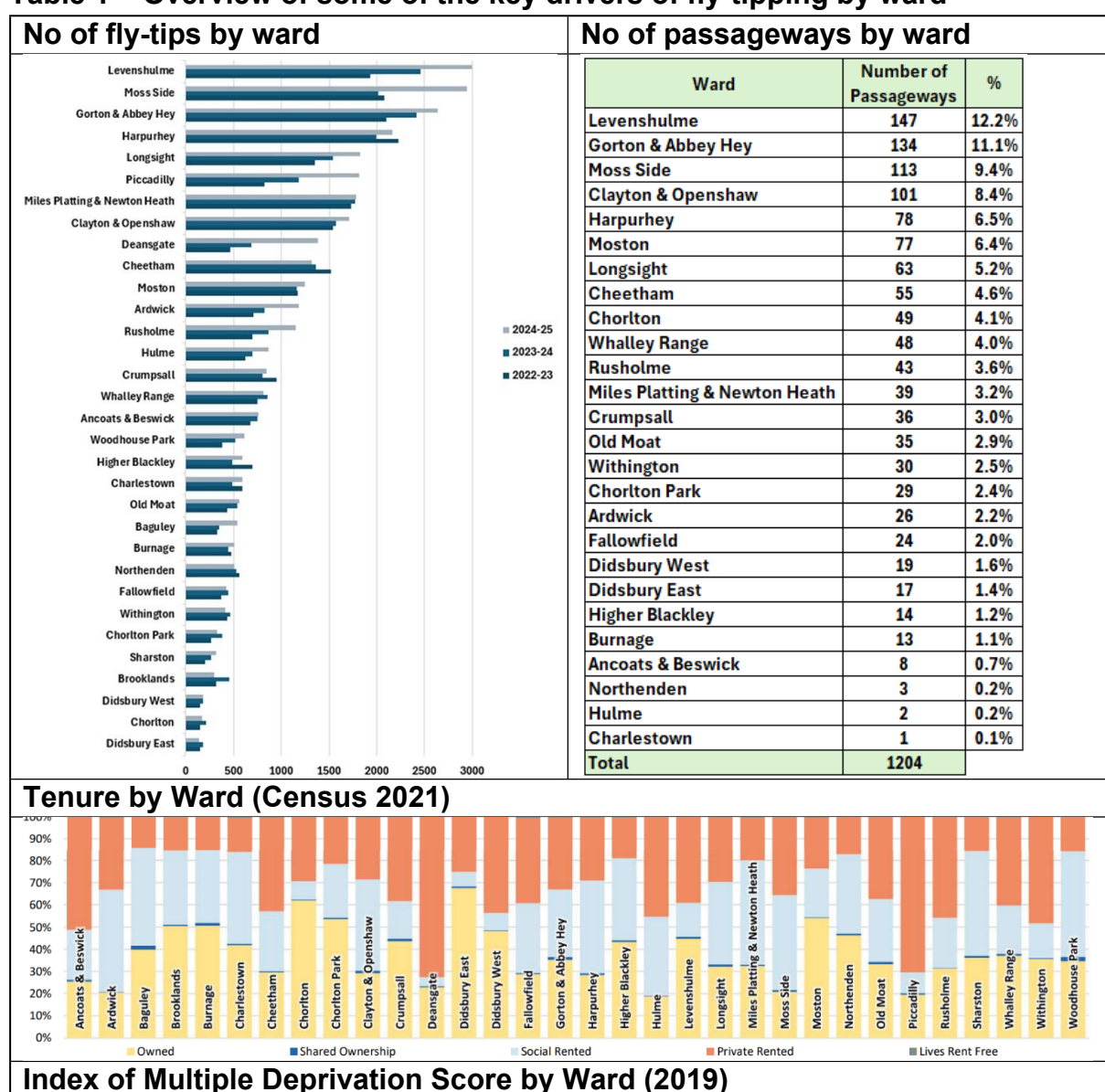
7.0 Key issues and challenges in 'Hotspot' areas

- 7.1 Analysis of performance data indicates that certain wards are experiencing persistent challenges related to fly-tipping, waste management, and environmental cleanliness. These issues have a detrimental impact on residents' wellbeing and their perceptions of the local environment.
- 7.2 In recent years 'deep dive' exercises have been undertaken with the Performance Research & Intelligence Team and Keep Britain Tidy. By overlaying demand information spatially with census data and other insights, this has identified a number of recurring factors that appear to contribute to

the heightened risk in these areas. This includes elevated levels of deprivation, population growth, high population density, language spoken, residential transience, and specific property types and tenures.

- 7.3 Analysis shows an increase in the number of reports of fly tipping in passageways and currently these make up 30% of all requests for service in the city. The top 10 wards impacted by fly-tipping are in the north and central areas of the city. Table 1 shows that wards with the highest number of passageways have the highest number of fly-tipping requests. In 2024/25 33% of all fly tip requests came from Levenshulme, Moss Side and Gorton & Abbey Hey. These three wards combined also contain 33% of the total number of passageways in the city. The heatmaps on Table 2 shows how fly-tipping issues are increasing in this part of the city.

Table 1 – Overview of some of the key drivers of fly-tipping by ward



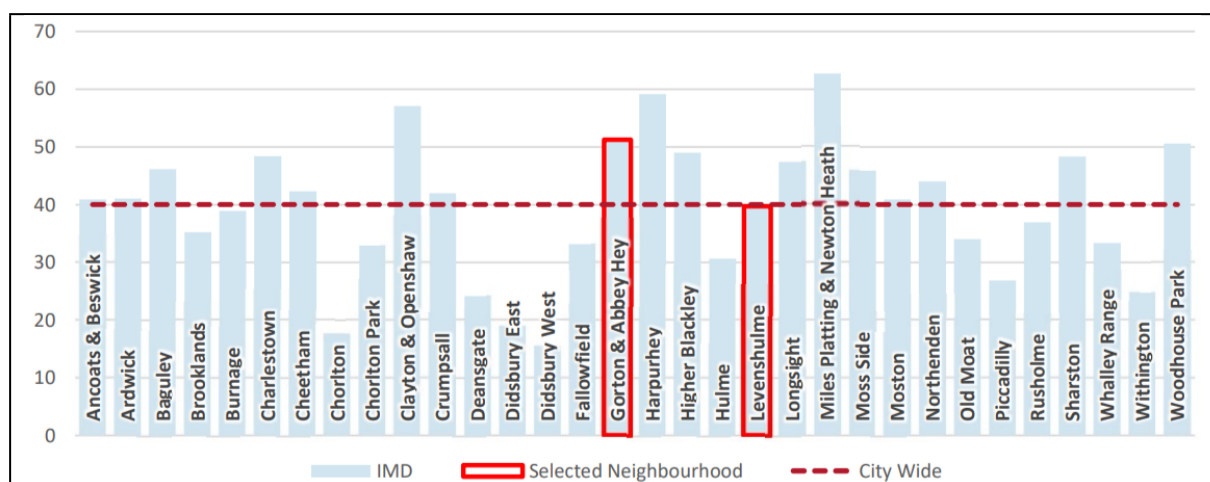
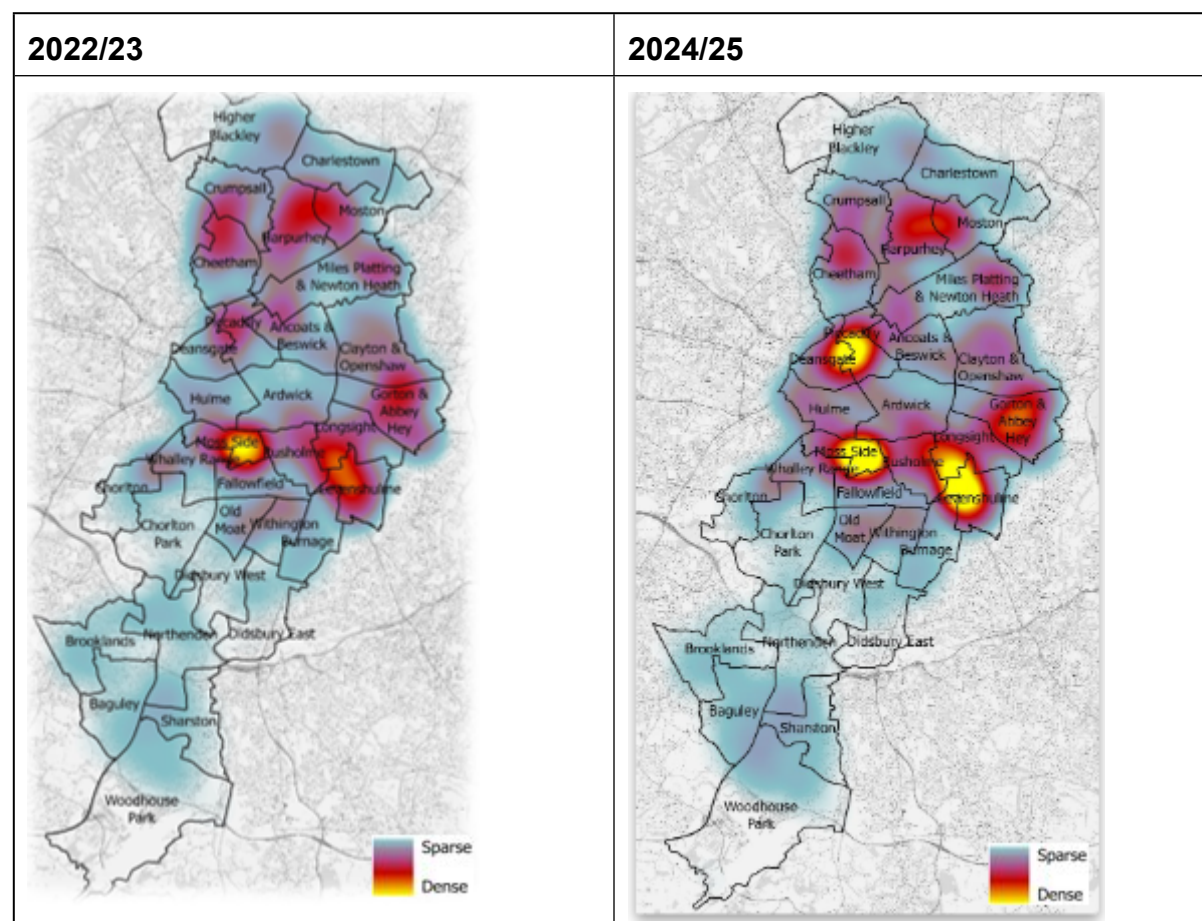


Table 2 - Fly tipping density maps



7.4 Key waste & recycling challenges include:

- Low recycling rates: Recycling rates are stagnating. Performance varies dependent on access to storage space and collection arrangement.
- Missed collections: Often caused by access issues.
- Bin returns: Bin returns by residents and by collection crews.

- Awareness of additional residual capacity: More promotion needed to those who need it.
- Caddy liner shortages: Residents can request online or collect from libraries, crews are not always able to meet demand of requests communicated by bags tied to bins.
- Contaminated recycling bins: A reducing issue. But system allows easy abuse of recycling bins to be utilised for extra rubbish disposal.
- Housing and property types: High private rental and limited storage space contribute to waste issues. Flats above shops are extremely problematic as access to a dedicated waste storage space is often not available.

7.5 Street Cleansing challenges include:

- High litter demand in some residential areas: Biffa's approach is in place, but deterioration is increasing.
- Parked cars obstructing cleaning: Alternative methods are being tested but needs to be expanded.
- Aging litter bins: Citywide replacement project almost complete.
- Litter on grass verges and in parks: There is increased activity on this and significant volunteer support in some parts of the city – but demand has increased, and Council resources have not kept pace.

7.6 Fly-tipping challenges include:

- Passageways are hotspots: 60% of reports are in top wards; targeted clearance and campaigns are in place.
- Mismanaged domestic waste: Black bags, furniture, and appliances are common.
- Enforcement challenges: We have focused on hotspot areas and use of CCTV.
- Council land fly-tipping: £100k allocated to improve response times.
- Commercial and household waste conflicts: Audits and postcode tools being developed.
- Landlord responsibilities: Work is underway to reinforce responsibilities, particularly in student areas.

7.7 Behaviour Change challenges include:

- Entrenched behaviours, low reporting in some neighbourhoods, and transient populations can impact progress.
- In some places, there is a need for increased ownership and responsibility among residents.

8.0 Understanding what drives attitudes and behaviours

- 8.1 A significant amount of research has been undertaken globally and locally by, government bodies, empirical researchers, charities and the waste sector to understand what drives attitudes and behaviours in relation to waste, recycling and fly-tipping. This section provides some insight into key sources

of research and expertise which the Council uses to inform its approach.

Recycling

- 8.2 Research by leading sustainability non-government organisation WRAP (Waste and Resources Action Programme) has shown that residents demonstrate several different attitudes and behaviours towards waste and recycling. Broadly, they can be split into the following categories:
- Committed recyclers – residents who recycle consistently.
 - Unreliable recyclers – residents who do recycle sometimes but are not committed.
 - Non-recyclers – Residents who are not recycling and not willing to engage with us. They will need compliance or service change to force them to change their behaviour.
 - Aware but undermined recyclers – Residents who are engaged (or want to be engaged) but are undermined by neighbours through communal facilities where recycling isn't used correctly. This covers some residents within communal areas and apartments.
- 8.3 Every year WRAP undertakes a national survey to understand how the populations attitudes and behaviours are shifting. In Manchester, WRAP have previously advised there are a mix of all four categories, but there is a higher prevalence of the Unreliable / Non recyclers and Aware but undermined recyclers due mainly to the property stock type and tenure. This is similar to other Core Cities, but less comparable to most GM Authorities. This is reflected in the differences in recycling rates across Greater Manchester.

Fly-tipping – research from Keep Britain Tidy

- 8.4 Fly-tipping is the illegal, often premeditated, dumping of waste—typically items the size of a bin bag or larger on land without permission or proper collection arrangements, and is distinct from littering. **Every year** local authorities in England deal with over 1 million fly-tipping incidents, with household waste making up 60% and most cases occurring on highways, typically involving waste volumes equivalent to a small van or a car boot.
- 8.5 Since 2017, Keep Britain Tidy has conducted extensive research into fly-tipping using a range of methods, including data analysis, interviews, focus groups, co-design workshops, and surveys across diverse communities. This multi-method approach has helped build a comprehensive understanding of fly-tipping behaviours, motivations, and the effectiveness of communication and service responses.
- 8.6 Residents often don't associate the term 'fly-tipping' with small-scale household dumping, so clearer, more relatable language and imagery are needed to help them recognise the behaviour. There's a widespread expectation that fly-tipping will be collected quickly and without consequence, reinforcing the idea that it's low-impact and acceptable. Some

council practices and service delivery issues may unintentionally encourage this behaviour, while the perceived hassle of using official waste services further drives it. Making responsible disposal easier and more accessible, alongside targeted support for households struggling to manage waste, is key to reducing fly-tipping and shifting responsibility back to residents. Appendix A summarises the key insights from KBT's research and recommended actions.

9.0 Summary, Next Steps and Recommendations

9.1 Summary of the key considerations for the future

Below is a summary of key considerations in relation to challenges faced -

- With increases in population, housing and business and in transient communities, there will be demands for increase in services.
- There is an identified need for differential/targeted approaches in some neighbourhoods, particularly where there are high levels of transience and poverty.
- It's recognised that some areas in the city experience high demand and challenges in developing ownership. Whilst there has been lots of intervention with short-term impact, issues can return quickly. This impacts on residents themselves and staff. In these, we may just have to intervene as part of a differentiated model.
- The rights and responsibilities of residents and businesses need to be clear and regularly reinforced. We should do this through targeted engagement, communication, and have service delivery that reflects diverse needs.
- If the council consistently plays its part, then communities/residents have trust in us, report and are more willing to play their part.
- There is a need to work with community groups for their ideas / insight in how we can collectively approach engagement / education / influencing activities to keep neighbourhoods clean and green (including national UoM/MMU insight).
- How neighbourhood management resources maintain pace with the City's growth.

9.2 Key areas identified for focus in 2025/26

Below are key areas of agreed focus for 25/26 -

- Develop a Fly-tip & litter reduction strategy for the city working with Keep Britain Tidy to provide external verification of approach.
- A HIT Team focused on tackling complex fly-tipping from flats above shops, businesses and passageways (recruitment process has now commenced).
- Additional £30k to support new communications / engagement.
- Integrated Neighbourhood Management programme agreed for the next 12 months.

- To further embed the Clean & Green governance arrangements and link into the new Ward Co-ordination process.
- Continue to develop partnership working to support this area – building on work undertaken through 2024/25.
- Develop a communications plan to support the programme.

9.3 Recommendations

The Committee is recommended to: -

Note the content of the report, the issues highlighted and endorse the key areas of work identified for 2025/26.

Provide feedback on the key considerations identified for the future and any further recommendations arising from this report.

Appendix 1

Insights & recommended actions to address fly-tipping (source: Keep Britain Tidy)

INSIGHT	ACTION
1. People don't think of small-scale householder fly-tipping when they see or hear the term 'fly-tipping'.	Reassess your use of imagery, threats and descriptive language with a critical eye.
2. There is an expectation that fly-tips will be collected quickly and without repercussion.	Communicate clearly, in a targeted manner, that fly-tipping in any form is not acceptable and not tolerated.
3. People perceive fly-tipping to be low impact.	Build new narratives around the real costs of fly-tipping.
4. Some council policies are unintentionally driving fly-tipping.	Carefully examine the totality of waste collection and disposal options from a user perspective.
5. Some types of fly-tipping are seen as more socially acceptable.	Tackle these excuses head-on in communications and action.
6. The 'hassle factor' is a significant driver of fly-tipping.	'Tip the balance' to make fly-tipping a less attractive option compared to the alternatives.
7. Some households are not managing their waste effectively.	Support residents in better managing their waste within the existing service.
8. The perceived threat of enforcement is low.	Increase the perceived threat of enforcement.

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